

# Qihua Dong (He/Him/His)

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## EDUCATION

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**Northeastern University, Boston, USA**

Sep 2023 – Present

PhD in Computer Engineering (Advisor: Prof. Raymond Fu); GPA: 3.96/4.00

Research interests: Multi-modal large language models, computer vision, artificial intelligence.

**City University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, China**

Sep 2017 – Jul 2021

BSc in Computer Science with Mathematics Minor; GPA: 3.89/4.3 (Top 10%)

Selected coursework: Mathematical Analysis; Enhanced Calculus and Linear Algebra; Discrete Mathematics; Statistic Processes; Data Structures and Advanced Programming; Design and Analysis of Algorithms.

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Reasoning, reinforcement learning, and multimodal LLMs; prior work in weakly supervised learning, segmentation, and medical images.

## SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

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### *Preprints and Under Review*

- **Qihua Dong**, Gozde Sahin, Pei Wang, Zhaowei Cai, Robik Shrestha, Hao Yang, Davide Modolo. “Visual Reasoning through Tool-supervised Reinforcement Learning.” *Submitted to CVPR* 2026.
- **Qihua Dong**, Luis Figueroa, Handong Zhao, Kushal Kafle, Jason Kuen, Zhihong Ding, Scott Cohen, Yun Fu. “CoT Referring: Chain-of-Thought Grounding Improve Localization in Referring Expression Tasks.” *Submitted to ICLR* 2026. [arXiv:2510.06243](#)
- **Qihua Dong**, Yang Kuo, Ju Lin, Handong Zhao, Yitian Zhang, Yizhou Wang, Huimin Zeng, Jianglin Lu, Yun Fu. “Ref-Adv: Exploring MLLM Visual Reasoning in Referring Expression Tasks.” *Submitted to ICLR* 2026. [OpenReview](#)

### *Peer-Reviewed Publications*

\*: *Equal contribution.*

- Hao Du\*, **Qihua Dong\***, Yan Xu, Jing Liao. “TDFormer: Top-Down Token Generation for 3D Medical Image Segmentation.” *IEEE JBHI* 2025. [DOI:10.1109/JBHI](#)
- **Qihua Dong**, Hao Du, Ying Song, Yan Xu, Jing Liao. “Preserving Tumor Volumes for Unsupervised Medical Image Registration.” *ICCV* 2023. [arXiv:2309.10153](#)
- Ruozhen He\*, **Qihua Dong\***, Jiayin Lin, Rynson Lau. “Weakly-Supervised Camouflaged Object Detection with Scribble Annotations.” *AAAI* 2023. [arXiv:2207.14083](#)
- Hao Du\*, **Qihua Dong\***, Yan Xu, Jing Liao. “Weakly-Supervised 3D Medical Image Segmentation using Geometric Prior and Contrastive Similarity.” *IEEE TMI* 2023. [arXiv:2302.02125](#)

### *Academic Service*

- **Outstanding Reviewer**, ICCV 2025.

## INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

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**Amazon, AGI Foundations Team, WA, USA**

May 2025 – Present

**Applied Scientist Intern**

Mentors: [Zhaowei Cai](#), [Pei Wang](#), [Hao Yang](#), [Gozde Sahin](#), [Robik Shrestha](#), [Davide Modolo](#)

Built multi-tool visual agents (zoom, draw-box, rotate) with GRPO-based training. Applied curriculum RL and created data pipelines for 7B/32B models with novel reward design, improving performance across chart, document, and high-resolution benchmarks.

**Adobe Research, CA, USA**

May 2024 – Feb 2025

## Research Intern

Mentors: [Luis Figueroa](#), [Handong Zhao](#), [Kushal Kafle](#), [Jason Kuen](#), [Zhihong Ding](#), [Scott Cohen](#)

Developed multimodal LLM for referring image segmentation with structured chain-of-thought reasoning.  
Created novel benchmarks with enriched annotations for complex referring expressions.

## RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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### Multi-modal LLM in Visual Understanding and Reasoning

Oct 2023 – Present

Northeastern University (Advisor: Prof. Raymond Fu)

Building multimodal LLMs capable of visual grounding, spatial reasoning, and zero-shot generalization for intelligent agent development with minimal fine-tuning via in-context examples.

### 3D Medical Imaging

May 2022 – Mar 2023

City University of Hong Kong (Advisors: Prof. [Jing Liao](#), Prof. [Yan Xu](#))

- Developed a volume-preserving registration network for tumor alignment with a task-specific loss.
- Designed a dynamic transformer for efficient medical image segmentation via foreground-aware tokenization.
- Proposed a weakly supervised segmentation framework combining geometric priors and contrastive pre-training, achieving 12.5% Dice improvement on benchmark datasets.

### Weakly-Supervised Camouflaged Object Detection

Dec 2021 – Jun 2022

City University of Hong Kong (Advisor: Prof. Rynson Lau)

Initiated the first weakly supervised formulation and dataset for camouflaged object detection with new consistency and feature losses, surpassing SOTA COD baselines by 11% MAE.

## ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

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### Texas A&M University, TX, USA

Oct 2022 – Jan 2023

Research Assistant (Remote) with Prof. Wenping Wang; contributed to computer vision and computer graphics projects focused on facial analysis.

### City University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, China

Aug 2021 – Aug 2023

Full-time Research Assistant with Prof. [Jing Liao](#); advanced 3D medical image analysis and weakly supervised learning projects.

### City University of Hong Kong, Hong Kong SAR, China

Sep 2020 – Feb 2021

Part-time Student Research Assistant with Prof. Jianping Wang; researched scheduling schemes for self-driving systems.

## HONORS AND SCHOLARSHIPS

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- First Class Honors, City University of Hong Kong, 2021.
- Bronze Medal, ICPC Asia Nanchang Regional Contest, 2019.
- Dean's List, City University of Hong Kong, 2017–2021.
- Full Tuition Scholarship, City University of Hong Kong, 2017–2021.

## SKILLS

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|--------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Programming</b> | Python, C++, Matlab, R, JavaScript, Java, CSS                              |
| <b>Frameworks</b>  | PyTorch, NumPy, Detectron2, scikit-image, MMDetection, MONAI, scikit-learn |
| <b>Languages</b>   | English: TOEFL 110 (Nov 2022); GRE 330 (Analytical Writing 3.5)            |